

Write Your Life Story - Printable Pack

The planning sheets from the book, and a lined page headed for each of the twenty chapters, to print as many times as you need.

The Timeline: My Life by Decade

One line per year is too many and one per decade too few; fill in what you remember, and leave the rest for later. The events of the world go in the last column, from your own memory or from a library book, so that your life sits in its time.

Years	Where I lived	What I was doing (school, work, family)	The big events of my life	What was happening in the world
0 to 10				
10 to 20				
20 to 30				
30 to 40				
40 to 50				
50 to 60				
60 to 70				
70 to 80				
80 and after				

The Family Tree

Names, years of birth and death, and where they lived. The generations above you are the ones only you can still supply.

	Name	Born (year, place)	Died (year, place)	What they did
Mother's mother				
Mother's father				
Father's mother				
Father's father				
Mother				
Father				
Brothers and sisters				
Me				
Husband, wife or partner				
Children				
Grandchildren				

The Short Version: Ten Questions, and the Interview Sheet

The ten questions. If the whole book is too much, or time is short, these ten answered in a page each is a life story, and a good one. They are also the ten to record, if writing is hard (Chapter 8).

1. Where were you born, and what was the house like that you grew up in?
2. What were your parents like, and what did they do all day?
3. What do you remember about school, and about growing up?
4. How did you meet the person you married, or the person who mattered most?
5. What work did you do, and what was it actually like?
6. What was it like when your children were small?
7. What was the hardest time of your life, and how did you get through it?
8. What was the happiest time?
9. Who have you lost, and what do you want remembered about them?
10. What have you learned, and what do you want the people who read this to know?

The interview sheet (for a grandchild, a friend or a volunteer to ask)

For recording rather than writing. The asker reads the question, presses record, and does not interrupt; silence is where the next memory comes from. One question a session is plenty. Write the date, the question number and the recording name here so the recordings can be found and, if wanted, typed up later.

Date	Question (number from the book or the short version)	Recording name	Typed up?

The Chapter Planner, the Title Page and the Dedication

The chapter planner. Tick a chapter when its first piece is written, and again when you think it is finished. Fifteen prompts is the menu, not the target: three good pieces make a chapter. The last column is for the prompt numbers of the pieces that will go in it.

Chapter	Started	Pieces	Finished	Prompt numbers of the pieces
1. Where I Come From				
2. The House I Grew Up In				
3. My Parents				
4. Grandparents and the Older Relatives				
5. Brothers, Sisters and Cousins				
6. School Days				
7. Growing Up				
8. Work and the Working Life				
9. Love and Marriage				
10. Becoming a Parent				
11. The Homes I Have Made				
12. Friends				
13. Food, Holidays and Celebrations				
14. Faith, Beliefs and Values				
15. The World I Lived Through				
16. Hard Times				
17. The Body, Health and Growing Older				
18. The Things I Made and Loved				

19. The People I Have Lost				
20. What I Know Now				

The title page

Copy this onto the first page of the book, in your own hand or typed, filling in the blanks.

Title: _____
by _____
Written at (place) _____ between (years) _____
For _____
Dedication (one line): _____ _____
A note from the writer (who you are, why you wrote this, in three or four sentences, in your own voice): _____ _____ _____ _____
What I would like to happen to this book and the originals: _____ _____

Chapter 1 - Where I Come From

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Chapter 2 - The House I Grew Up In

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Chapter 3 - My Parents

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Chapter 4 - Grandparents and the Older Relatives

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Chapter 5 - Brothers, Sisters and Cousins

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 6 - School Days

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 7 - Growing Up

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Chapter 8 - Work and the Working Life

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 9 - Love and Marriage

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 10 - Becoming a Parent

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 11 - The Homes I Have Made

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 12 - Friends

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

This image shows a full page of blank white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a template for writing or drawing. There are no margins, text, or other markings present.

Chapter 13 - Food, Holidays and Celebrations

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page, providing a template for writing. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.

Chapter 14 - Faith, Beliefs and Values

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 15 - The World I Lived Through

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 16 - Hard Times

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 19 - The People I Have Lost

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Chapter 20 - What I Know Now

Prompt number: _____ Date: _____

[illegible]

Continuation Page

Chapter: _____ Prompt number: _____ Page: _____

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.